# 3.4

## Bharat Darshan and Eastern Command

After their wedding at Ambala, Isha and Simon went on their honeymoon to Manali and Shimla. Isha had fallen in love with Shimla, the quaint colonial-style houses, each with a history of its own, and the wooded hills, with their forests of pine and enticing timber trails. When they came back to Ambala, Isha remarked, 'I wish you get posted to Shimla.' Well. I guess her wishes were heard and answered. When my posting came to the ARTRAC rather than to one of the operational commands, whispers started floating around that I was being sidelined and out of the running for the top job. I had neither canvassed for any assignment nor had Gen Rawat asked me for my choice nor indeed given even a hint of what he was planning for me. Right from the time Gen Ashok Kapur had sent me to the Regimental Centre as a young Captain, I had always gone with the flow. '*Akhir kismat naam ki bhi kuchh cheez hoti hai*'—there's also something called destiny.

Unlike all other appointments, where there is a four- to seven-day handing/taking-over period when both the officers are in station, the same is not the convention when it comes to Army Commanders. One person leaves the garrison and only then does the next incumbent arrive. Veena and I staged forward

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